LESSON 1: REGISTERS

Types of registers and communicative competence

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What is a register?

A speaker's use of language in **different circumstances**, written or spoken: word choice, definitions, **tone of voice, facial expressions** and other verbal and non-verbal cues.

- We behave differently depending on **who we are talking to**, so our language shows **stylistic variation**
- Registers are shaped by **social occasion, purpose, participants (gender, age) and context**

TYPES OF REGISTERS (BY SPEECH)

- **Intimate** – **private**; between close **family members** or intimate partners (pet names, half-sentences)
- **Casual** – **peers and friends**; **slang, jargon, street language, gay language**, even vulgar words
- **Consultative** – the **standard** style; **professional or mutually acceptable** language; **two-way**
  - teacher–student, employer–employee, **doctor–patient**, **judge–lawyer**, President–constituents
- **Formal** – formal settings; **one-way**, respectful, academic and legal
  - **sermons**, **State of the Nation Address**, formal speeches, **a judge's pronouncement**
- **Frozen** – **"frozen in time"**, never changes; ceremonies
  - **Preamble to the Constitution**, **Lord's Prayer**, **Pledge of Allegiance / Panatang Makabayan**

Consultative vs formal?

Both are respectful. **Consultative is two-way** (an exchange, e.g. a judge talking with a lawyer); **formal is one-way** (e.g. a judge reading the verdict, a sermon, SONA).

Formal vs frozen?

A graduation speech or SONA is **formal**: new words each time. The Lord's Prayer is **frozen**: the same words every time.

Note: Exam trap: the **same person** can use different registers. A judge **discussing** a motion = consultative; a judge **reading** the verdict = formal.

COMMUNICATIVE COMPETENCE

- All registers can be part of **any** of these competencies
- **Linguistic** – grammar, structure, **phonology, morphology, semantics** and the **5 macro skills**
- **Sociolinguistic** – appropriate **words, expressions, attitude and body language** for a topic, setting and group; "language in society"
  - e.g. using **po and opo** with your friend's grandparents
- **Strategic** – **clarifying** and finding solutions to communication **ambiguities and confusion**
  - e.g. rephrasing directions and pointing on a map for a confused tourist
- **Discourse** – **initiating, developing, turn-taking, claiming, shifting, repairing and terminating** conversations
  - e.g. waiting for a pause, adding your point, inviting a quiet member to speak

Note: Strategic fixes a **breakdown**; **discourse** runs the **conversation** (turns, shifts, endings).

BRITISH VS AMERICAN ENGLISH

SPELLING PATTERNS (BRITISH → AMERICAN)

- **-our → -or** – colour → color, honour → honor

- **-re** → **-er** – centre → center, theatre → theater
- **-ise** → **-ize** – realise → realize, organise → organize
- **-ll-** → **-l-** – traveller → traveler, cancelled → canceled
- **-mme** → **-m** – programme → program

WORDS (BRITISH = AMERICAN)

- football = **soccer** | autumn = **fall** | flat = **apartment** | biscuit = **cookie**
- trousers = **pants** | petrol = **gasoline** | lorry = **truck** | queue = **line**
- torch = **flashlight** | rubber = **eraser** | sweets = **candy** | sofa = **couch**
- tin = **can** | tap = **faucet** | wardrobe = **closet** | nappy = **diaper**

FILIPINISMS

What is a Filipinism?

An English expression shaped by Filipino usage that differs from standard English.

- **Xerox** → **photocopy**
- **Sewer** (dressmaker) → **tailor / seamstress**
- **There's traffic** → **there's heavy traffic**
- **Bottomless** (drinks) → **refillable**
- **Come again?** → **Could you say that again, please?**
- **Fill up** (a form) → **fill out / fill in**
- **Pass by** my office → **drop by** my office
- **Fall in line** → **get in line / make a line**
- **For a while** → **just a second / just a moment**

——— END OF LESSON ———

LESSON 2: GENDER-NEUTRAL AND POLITICALLY CORRECT LANGUAGE

Inclusive word choices

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What is gender-neutral language?

A generic term covering **non-sexist, inclusive or gender-fair** language (**European Parliament, 2018**).

- **Purpose** – avoid word choices that may be **biased, discriminatory or demeaning** by implying **one sex is the norm**
- Also **reduces gender stereotyping**, **promotes social change** and helps achieve **gender equality**
- Gender-neutral pronouns: **they, them, their**

GENDER-NEUTRAL WORDS

- **chairman → chair, chairperson, coordinator**
- **forefathers → ancestors, forebears**
- **man-made → artificial, manufactured**
- **common man → average / ordinary person**
- **freshman → first-year student**
- **stewardess → flight attendant**
- **congressman → legislator, representative**
- **mailman / postman → mail carrier, postal worker**
- **policeman → police officer**
- **brotherhood → solidarity**
- **to man** (a booth) **→ to operate, to cover, to staff**
- **man** (all people) **→ people, person, individual**

Note: Remove the gender, don't **swap** it: chairwoman, postwoman and saleslady are **still gendered**. "His or her" is fair, but the slides prefer **their**.

POLITICALLY CORRECT (PC) WORDS

What is politically correct language?

Terms meant to give the **least amount of offense** when describing groups identified by **race, gender, culture or sexual orientation**; rooted in a desire to **eliminate exclusion** (**Britannica, 2024**).

- **cheating → academic dishonesty**
- **ugly → aesthetically challenged**
- **negro → black**
- **disabled → differently-abled**
- **drug addict → drug dependent**
- **broken home → dysfunctional family**
- **poor → economically marginalized**
- **old → elderly, senior**
- **dishonest → ethnically disoriented**
- **deaf → hearing impaired**
- **squatters → informal settlers**
- **mental retardation → intellectual disability**
- **stupid → intellectually impaired**
- **short people → vertically challenged**
- **body odor → nondiscretionary fragrance**
- **homeless → outdoor urban**
- **fat → people of mass, horizontally challenged**
- **rape victim → rape survivor**
- **perverted → sexually dysfunctional**
- **psychopath → socially misaligned**
- **computer illiterate → technologically challenged**
- **blind → visually challenged**

Note: Look-alikes: **informal settlers** (no land title) vs **outdoor urban** (no home); **hearing impaired** (deaf) vs **visually challenged** (blind); **academic dishonesty** (cheating in school) vs **ethnically disoriented** (dishonest in general).

END OF LESSON

LESSON 3: PHONETICS

Sounds, spelling, consonants and vowels

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CONSONANT CHART (SLIDE 36)

Manner \ Place	Bilabial	Labiodental	Interdental	Alveolar	Palatal	Velar	Glottal
Stops / plosives	**p** b			**t** d		**k** g	**ʔ**
Fricatives		**f** v	**θ** ð	**s** z	**š** ž		**h**
Affricates					**č** ǰ		
Nasals	m			n		ŋ	
Lateral liquid				l			
Retroflex liquid				r			
Glides	w				y		

Note: Red = voiceless, black = voiced. **Row = manner**, **column = place**. All **nasals, liquids and glides are voiced**. Slide symbols: **š** = sh (ship), **ž** = zh (beige), **č** = ch (chair), **ǰ** = j (judge), **y** = /j/ (yes).

VOWELS (IPA VS DICTIONARY)

IPA	Description	Example words	Dictionary
i	high front tense unrounded	beat, east, leap	iy, e, ē, i:
ɪ	high front lax unrounded	bit, if, big, mirror	i
e	mid front tense unrounded	bait, reign, great, cake	ey, a, ā
ɛ	mid front lax unrounded	bet, edge, said, guess	e, ĕ
æ	low front lax unrounded	bat, laugh, cat, and	a, ă
ə	mid central tense unrounded	among, sofa, ago	ə
ʌ	mid central lax unrounded	but, tough, another, cut	u, ə
u	high back tense rounded	boot, who, sewer, duty	uw, ü, oo
ʊ	high back lax rounded	book, put, foot, could	ù, oo
o	mid back tense rounded	boat, beau, grow, coat	o, ō
ɔ	mid back lax rounded	bought, caught, ball, law	ô
ɑ	low back lax unrounded	pot, father, honor, cot	a, ä
ɝ / ɚ	r-colored	earn, work, bird / player, father	ûr / ər

PHONETICS BASICS

What is phonetics?

The **scientific study of speech sounds** (phones, phonemes).

- **Segmentals** – the individual sounds: **consonants, vowels, diphthongs**
- **Suprasegmentals (prosodic features)** – stress, pitch, intonation, etc. (not in the midterm)

SOUND VS SPELLING

- **Different letters, same sound** – **to, too, two**; through, threw; clue, shoe, Sioux (8 spellings of one vowel)
- **Same letter, different sounds** – **a** in cake, mat, call, any, sofa (**5 sounds**); **s** in see /s/, pleasure /š, ž/, resign /z/
- **Two letters, one sound** – **gh** (rough), **ph** (physics), **ea** (head)
- **Silent letters** – bomb, cake, **pneumonia, knee, debt, receipt**
- **p + h = /f/** – philosophy, physics, photograph
- **c + i, e, y = /s/** – city, cigar, certain, cent, cyst
- **c + a, o, u or word-final = /k/** – cat, cone, cup, custom, **plastic**
- **electric /k/ → electricity /s/** – spelling stays the same even when the sound changes

How is "ghoti" read as "fish"?

gh as in rou**gh** (/f/) + **o** as in w**o**men (/ɪ/) + **ti** as in na**ti**on (/š/).

HOW CONSONANTS ARE DESCRIBED

- Air from the lungs is **obstructed** in the mouth or throat
- **Place** – **where** the airstream is obstructed
- **Manner** – **how** it is obstructed
- **Voicing** – do the **vocal cords vibrate**? **Voiced (+)** = vibrate; **voiceless (–)** = no vibration
- Vocal cords sit in the **larynx (voice box)**: close together = vibrate; apart = no vibration

PLACES OF ARTICULATION

- **Bilabial** – both lips: **p, b, m, w**
- **Labiodental** – upper teeth + lower lip: **f, v**
- **Interdental** – tongue tip **between the teeth**: **θ** (think), **ð** (this); hard for **second-language learners**
- **Alveolar** – tongue tip + **tooth (alveolar) ridge**: **t, d, s, z, n, l, r**
- **Palatal / alveo-palatal / post-alveolar** – **blade** of the tongue + **hard palate**: **š, ž, č, ǰ, y**
  - /ž/ rarely **begins** a word: **genre**, Jacques (foreign words)
- **Velar** – **back** of the tongue + **soft palate (velum)**: **k, g, ŋ**
- **Glottal** – the **glottis** (space between the vocal folds): **h** and the **glottal stop ʔ** (uh-oh)

MANNERS OF ARTICULATION

- **Stops / plosives** – **complete blockage**, then release: **p, b, t, d, k, g**
- **Fricatives / continuants** – **partial** obstruction → **friction**: **f, v, θ, ð, s, z, š, ž** (and h)
- **Affricates** – a **stop + fricative**: **č** (chug), **ǰ** (jug)
- **Nasals / sonorants** – **soft palate lowered**, air out through the **nose**: **m, n, ŋ**
- **Liquids / approximants** – air flows smoothly: **l** (**lateral**: air over the **sides** of the tongue), **r** (**retroflex**: tongue tip **curled back**)
- **Glides / semi-vowels** – wide opening, like vowels: **w, y**
- **Sibilants** – hissing fricatives: **s, z, š, ž**
- **Obstruents** – **stops, fricatives, affricates** (no air through the nose)

Note: Labial shortcut: bilabial + labiodental sounds (**p, b, m, w, f, v**) are all made with the **lips**, so a group can mix the two columns.

READING THE CHART (QUIZ FORMATS)

ODD ONE OUT

- Three sounds share **one thing** – the **same row** (manner), **same column** (place) or **same color** (voicing); the fourth does not
  - **/t/ /k/ /g/ /v/ → /v/** (the others are stops)
  - **/m/ /p/ /w/ /k/ → /k/** (the others are bilabial)
  - **/s/ /k/ /š/ /l/ → /l/** (the others are voiceless)
  - **/f/ /b/ /p/ /ŋ/ → /ŋ/** (the others use the lips)

VOICING + PLACE + MANNER LABELS

- **/p/** voiceless bilabial stop | **/b/** voiced bilabial stop
- **/t/** voiceless alveolar stop | **/d/** voiced alveolar stop
- **/k/** voiceless velar stop | **/g/** voiced velar stop
- **/f/** voiceless labiodental fricative | **/v/** voiced
- **/θ/** voiceless interdental fricative | **/ð/** voiced
- **/s/** voiceless alveolar fricative | **/z/** voiced
- **/š/** voiceless palatal fricative | **/ž/** voiced
- **/č/** voiceless palatal affricate | **/ǰ/** voiced
- **/h/** voiceless glottal fricative | **/ʔ/** glottal stop
- **/m/** bilabial, **/n/** alveolar, **/ŋ/** velar – all **voiced nasals**
- **/l/** lateral, **/r/** retroflex – **voiced alveolar liquids**
- **/w/** bilabial, **/y/** palatal – **voiced glides**

SOUND RULES (FIND THE FEATURE)

- **a → an** before **apple, hour, honest, umbrella** – they all begin with a **vowel sound** (the h in hour is silent; university and one begin with **/y/** and **/w/**, so they take "a")
- **Skipped l and r** (walk, talk, calm; car, park) – the sounds that drop are the **liquids / approximants**
- **Plural -s** = /s/ after voiceless (cats), /z/ after voiced (dogs) → **voicing**
- **Past -ed** = /t/ (walked) vs /d/ (played) → **voicing**
- **in- → im-** before **p, b, m** (impossible) → matches the **place** (bilabial)
- **Bankerohan → "Bangkerohan"** – /n/ (alveolar nasal) becomes **/ŋ/** (velar nasal) before the **velar /k/**: same manner, new **place** (nasal assimilation)
- **"fink" for think** – θ → f: both **voiceless fricatives**, only the **place** changes
- **"pish" for fish** – f → p: place and manner change, both stay **voiceless**
- **"bery" for very** – v → b: both stay **voiced**
- **t vs d, k vs g** – same place and manner; differ **only in voicing**

PHONETIC SPELLING

- Read symbol by symbol with the charts: **/θɪŋk/** think, **/šɪp/** ship, **/šip/** sheep, **/čɪp/** chip, **/ǰʌǰ/** judge, **/mɛžɚ/** measure, **/sɪŋ/** sing, **/bot/** boat, **/bɔt/** bought, **/baɪt/** bite, **/haʊs/** house, **/bɔɪ/** boy
- **Not English words**: sound combinations English never uses, e.g. starting with **/ŋ/, /tl/, /dl/, /zb/**

Note: Watch the vowel: **/šɪp/ ship** vs **/šip/ sheep**, **/bot/ boat** vs **/bɔt/ bought** vs **/but/ boot**.

VOWELS

- Vowels: **wide opening**, little obstruction; vary by **region, social class, education, age and gender**
- **Four features** – **tongue height** (high, mid, low), **advancement** (front, central, back), **tense vs lax**, **lip rounding**
- **Tense** – extra muscle tension, tongue slightly **higher** (beat, boot); **lax** – no extra tension (bit, book)
- **Rounded** – only the **back** vowels **u, ʊ, o, ɔ**
- **Diphthongs** (complex vowels) – **aɪ** bite, eye, sky | **aʊ** bout, house, now | **ɔɪ** boy, coin, voice
- **Rhoticization** – **r-colored** vowels: **ɝ** (bird, work), **ɚ** (player)

————— END OF LESSON —————